

01 SMALL TALK

Coffee or a meal — which is better for meeting up with friends?

Do you prefer big groups or small groups when you go out?

What did you do last weekend?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

1 ~~"I have a some on going."~~

✓ "I'm kind of seeing someone."

'썸(some)'은 콩글리시예요. 초반 단계는 seeing someone이나 talking으로 말해요.

2 ~~"We meeting for 3 months."~~

✓ "We've been seeing each other for 3 months."

3개월째 계속이니 have been -ing가 필요하고, be동사 없이는 문장이 안 돼요.

3 ~~"He gave me a big impression."~~

✓ "He made a big impression on me."

impression은 give가 아니라 make/leave와 짝이고, on me로 대상을 붙여요.

03 오늘의 워업

앉은 자리에서 손가락으로 A(1) 또는 B(2) 표시. 한 라운드마다 한 명 짧게 이유 한 문장. 5분 안에 끝.

WARM-UP

This or That · 빠른 5라운드

1

Dating app vs Set up by a friend

2

Meet naturally over time vs Decide fast on the first date

3

See the profile first vs Know nothing before meeting

4

Text for a week first vs Meet in person right away

5

Check the conditions upfront vs Let the feeling decide

Dating Apps and Setups — Realistic or Too Forced?

BACKGROUND

요즘 만남은 자연스러운 만남만 기다리기엔 현실이 조용하고, 앱이나 소개팅을 열어두기엔 또 너무 의도적인 느낌이 들 수 있어요. 자연스럽게 만나고 싶은 마음은 있지만, 아무것도 하지 않으면 정말 아무 일도 안 생기는 경우도 많아요. 데이트 앱이나 소개팅이 꼭 가벼운 선택만은 아니에요. 누군가에게는 시간을 아끼는 현실적인 방법이고, 누군가에게는 감정이 시작되기 전에 조건부터 보는 느낌이라 부담스러워요. 결국 핵심은 만남의 방식보다 그 방식 안에서 얼마나 편하고 솔직하게 대화할 수 있는지에요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Waiting for an organic meeting can sound romantic, but real life can be quiet. Work, routines, friend groups, and limited free time may not create many natural chances to meet someone. Dating apps and setups can feel more direct, but they can also feel forced. People disagree because they want different kinds of comfort. Some see apps or introductions as practical ways to save time and meet people outside their usual circle. Others feel awkward because the purpose is clear from the beginning. The real question is not only how people meet, but whether the method lets them feel relaxed and honest. Dating standards are rarely only about romance. They also show how people understand fairness, attention, pride, money, privacy, and emotional safety. The same behavior may look thoughtful to one person and careless to another, because people read small signals through past experience.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

it felt too forced — 너무 작위적이었어요

break the ice — 어색한 분위기를 풀다

have a crush on someone — 누군가에게 반하다

a deal-breaker — 절대 양보 못 하는 조건

you never know until you try — 해보기 전엔 모른다

put yourself out there — 용기 내서 적극적으로 나서다

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, dating apps feel ___ to me — but ___.

The way I see it, they feel ___ because ___.

I'd rather ___ than ___ because ___.

If I had to choose, I'd ___ — otherwise ___.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'just download the app' or a 'wait and bump into someone' kind of person?
- 2 When was the last time a friend or family member tried to set you up with someone?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick: dating app, blind date setup, or meeting through hobbies — which feels most like 'you'?
- 4 Finish this: 'When someone offers to set me up on a blind date, I usually ___.'

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Do dating apps and setups feel realistic or too forced to you? Why?

↳ *Honestly, dating apps feel ___ to me — but ___.*

↳ *The way I see it, they feel ___ because ___.*

Q2. Would you rather wait for an organic meeting, or create more chances yourself?

↳ *I'd rather ___ than ___ because ___.*

↳ *If I had to choose, I'd ___ — otherwise ___.*

Q3. Do apps save time, or do they make dating feel like filtering people?

↳ *It depends on ___, but most of the time ___.*

↳ *In my case, apps ___ — and that's why ___.*

Q4. What would make a planned first meeting feel less awkward for you?

↳ *What helps me relax is ___.*

↳ *The thing is, a first meeting feels easier when ___.*

Q5. Can a setup still feel romantic if the conversation is really good?

↳ *I'd say yes, because ___ matters more than ___.*

↳ *When I think about it, a setup can ___ as long as ___.*